

Room Status Guide

How rooms move from Dirty to Inspected — who does what, and why

For hotel management, housekeeping and front office · October 2026

In one page

Hestia now follows the standard hotel housekeeping flow. Every room moves through the same steps, each step belongs to the right person, and the app only shows each person the actions that are theirs at that moment. The same rules are checked again on the server, so they cannot be bypassed.

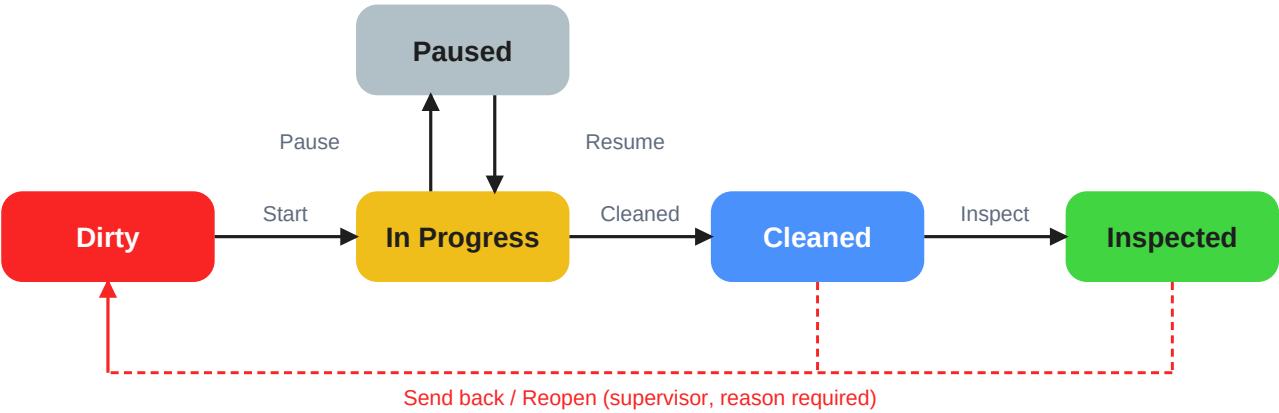
- **Room attendants** do the cleaning steps on **their own** rooms: start, pause, resume, cleaned, and report Do Not Disturb, Refuse Service or Return Later.
- **Supervisors and housekeeping leadership** assign rooms, inspect cleaned rooms, and send rooms back with a reason. They do not do the attendant's steps — except, when truly needed, **on the attendant's behalf**, with a reason that is recorded.
- **Front Office** sees every room's status (Inspected = ready to check in), and can set a promise time and mark a room priority.
- A room can no longer skip steps: it cannot go from Dirty straight to Cleaned or Inspected.
- Everything important is recorded in the room's history, and the right people are notified.

Good to know Nothing in day-to-day use needs to be configured. The behaviour below is the default for every hotel; a few options can be adjusted per hotel (see "Hotel settings").

Before you start Please make sure every device has the latest version of the Hestia app. Older versions cannot change room status under the new rules.

1. The journey of a room

Every room is always in exactly one state. The diagram shows the normal path from top-left to top-right, the pause loop, the supervisor's "send back", and the guest situations that interrupt service. Cleaned and Inspected are each confirmed with a short checklist.



Guest situations (from Dirty, or from In Progress, which then returns to Dirty):

Do Not Disturb

Refuse Service

Return Later

When the situation ends (sign removed, guest wants service, time to go back) the room is Dirty again, ready to start.

State	What it means
● Dirty	The room needs cleaning. This is where every room starts the day.
● In Progress	The attendant is cleaning it now. The cleaning timer is running.
● Paused	The attendant stepped away (break, fetching supplies). The timer is stopped.
● Cleaned	The attendant finished and completed the clean checklist. Waiting for inspection.
● Inspected	A supervisor checked it and completed the inspection checklist. Ready for the guest.
● Do Not Disturb	A DND sign is on the door. The attendant re-checks it on a schedule.
● Refuse Service	The guest declined service today, with a reason.
● Return Later	The guest asked for service at a later time. The attendant is reminded at that time.

2. Who does what

Role	Typical job titles	Can do
Room Attendant	Room attendant	The cleaning steps, on rooms assigned to them only. One room in progress at a time.
Supervisor	Supervisor, senior supervisor, coordinator	Assign / reassign / unassign rooms, inspect, send back, reopen, clear guest situations, priority, flag, promise time. Can act for an attendant with a reason.
Housekeeping leadership	Executive housekeeper, HK manager, assistant manager	Everything a supervisor can do.
Front Office	Front office agents, senior front office	Sees all statuses. Sets or removes promise times. Marks a room priority. No housekeeping steps.
Everyone else	Porters, laundry, public area, concierge, in-room dining, technical	Sees rooms they have access to. Can raise a flag where their role allows. No status changes.

Note The app decides what to show from the person's job title, which the hotel already sets up. No extra setup is needed for the new flow.

3. For room attendants

Open the room from your Rooms list, or tap its status on the card. The **Change Status** menu only shows the steps you can take right now. If an option is not there, it is not your step yet.

When the room is...	You will see	You will not see
● Dirty	In Progress (start), Do Not Disturb, Refuse Service, Return Later	Cleaned, Inspected, Pause
● In Progress	Pause, Cleaned (opens the checklist), Return Later, Refuse Service. Undo start for the first 2 minutes.	Inspected, Do Not Disturb
● Paused	Resume, Return Later	Cleaned — resume first, so your time is counted correctly
● Do Not Disturb	Still DND (record another check), Sign removed	Everything else
● Refuse Service	Service back on (the guest changed their mind)	Everything else
● Return Later	In Progress (start when you are back), change the time, Clear return	Everything else
● Cleaned / ● Inspected	Nothing — the room is finished for you	Everything

Cleaning a room, step by step

1. Find the room in your list (only your assigned rooms are shown). It is **Dirty**.
2. Tap the status, choose **In Progress**. The timer starts. Tapped by mistake? Choose **Undo start** within 2 minutes — the room goes back to Dirty and no time is recorded.
3. Need to step away? Choose **Pause**; the timer stops. Choose **Resume** when you are back.
4. When finished, choose **Cleaned**. Complete the clean checklist, add photos or a note if needed, and slide to confirm.
5. The room is now **Cleaned** and your supervisor is notified. Your part is done.

Rules that help you

- **One room at a time.** You cannot start a second room while one is in progress. Pause or finish the first one.
- **Only your rooms.** You can only change rooms assigned to you.
- **Guest situations.** Use Do Not Disturb when the sign is up, Refuse Service when the guest declines (choose a reason), and Return Later when the guest asks you to come back (choose the time). If you were cleaning, the room returns to Dirty.

4. For supervisors and housekeeping leadership

Assigning rooms

- Assign from the room card's **Assign** button, from a room's detail page, or in bulk from **Staff** → **See rooms** → **Action** (Assign, Reassign, Unassign).
- A room must be assigned before anyone can start it. An unassigned room says "Assign a room attendant to start cleaning this room."
- The attendant is notified the moment a room is assigned to them.

Reassigning a room that is being cleaned

- You never have to wait. Reassigning a room that is In Progress **pauses it** and hands it to the new attendant, who resumes it.
- The first attendant is told, and the time they spent is recorded in the room's history.

Inspecting

1. A room shows **Cleaned**. Open its status and choose **Inspected**.
2. Go through the inspection checklist and slide to confirm. The room is **Inspected** — ready for the guest.
3. If it fails, choose **Send back to Dirty** on the checklist. The reason "Failed inspection" is recorded, and the attendant is notified with that reason.

Sending back and reopening

- On a **Cleaned** room, **Send back** returns it to Dirty. On an **Inspected** room, **Reopen** does the same (for example after a guest complaint).
- A reason is always required: **Failed inspection**, **Guest complaint** or **Missed item**. The attendant is told why, and the cleaning timer starts fresh.

Acting for an attendant (override)

Cleaning steps belong to the attendant. When an attendant cannot use the app — a dead phone, they left mid-shift — a supervisor can take the step **for** them:

1. Open the room's status. The menu says "Cleaning steps are Zoe's. Acting for them asks for a reason."
2. Choose the step, then a reason: **Device issue**, **Staff absent** or **Correction**.
3. The step is done, the room's history reads e.g. "Cleaned for Zoe Cakeri: Device issue", and Zoe is notified.

Important An override never skips a step — a room still goes Dirty → In Progress → Cleaned. It changes who acts, not the order.

Guest situations

- Supervisors receive Do Not Disturb, Refuse Service and Return Later notices, and the DND welfare-check alert when a sign has been up past the hotel's cut-off time.
- Supervisors can clear these situations (for example after a welfare check): choose **Sign removed**, **Service back on** or **Clear return**.

5. For front office

- **Status at a glance:** Inspected means the room is ready to check in. Cleaned means it is waiting for inspection.
- **Promise time:** when you promise a guest an early room, set the promise time on that room. Housekeeping sees it on the card and the attendant is notified. Remove it if plans change.
- **Priority:** mark a room priority when it is needed urgently. Housekeeping sees it immediately.
- Front office does not change housekeeping status — that keeps one clear owner for each step.

6. What happens automatically

When	What happens
An attendant starts a room	The supervisor who assigned it is told "Cleaning started" — after 2 minutes, so a mistaken tap that was undone never sends a notice.
A room is cleaned	The supervisor who assigned it is notified.
A room is sent back	The attendant is notified, with the reason.
A step is taken for an attendant	The attendant is notified, with who did it and why.
A Do Not Disturb re-check is due	The attendant is reminded (or the supervisors, if nobody is assigned).
DND past the cut-off	Supervisors get a welfare-check alert.
Return Later time arrives	The attendant is reminded; if 30 minutes pass without starting, supervisors are told.
A shift ends	Unfinished rooms that nobody is cleaning go back to the unassigned pool for the next shift, and the supervisor is told how many. Rooms being cleaned stay with their attendant.
A new day starts	Refusals and return-laters from yesterday end. Rooms a guest slept in that were Cleaned or Inspected go back to Dirty for today's service.

7. Records and accountability

- Each room's **History** tab shows what happened and who did it — including send-backs and reopenings with their reason, steps taken for an attendant, undone starts, and handovers between attendants.
- Cleaning time is measured by the system from the moment a room is started, excluding pauses. It drives credits, the Staff screen and the Activity reports.
- Every rule is checked on the server as well as in the app, so the flow is followed the same way on every phone.
- If two people act on the same room at the same moment, one action is applied and the other person sees "...is not available while the room is... Refresh to see its current state." Nothing is overwritten silently.
- A tap repeated on a poor connection is applied only once.

8. Hotel settings

These are set per hotel. The defaults below are active now; ask us to change any of them.

Setting	Default	What it does
Undo start window	2 minutes	How long an attendant can undo a mistaken start.
Shift end	Return to pool	Unfinished rooms go back to the unassigned pool at the end of a shift. Alternative: keep them assigned.
New-day reset	On	Rooms a guest slept in go back to Dirty each morning. Can be turned off.
Status rules	On	The flow described in this guide. Can be paused for a hotel during a transition.

9. Questions we expect

An option I used to have is missing.

The menu only shows the steps that are yours for the room's current state. For example, Cleaned only appears once the room is In Progress, and Inspected only for supervisors once the room is Cleaned.

I started the wrong room.

Choose Undo start within 2 minutes. After that, Pause it and start the right one.

It says another room is still in progress.

You can work one room at a time. Pause or finish the room it names, then start the next.

An attendant's phone died mid-clean.

A supervisor can act for them with the reason "Device issue", or reassign the room — it will be handed over paused, with the time so far kept.

A cleaned room had an issue after inspection.

A supervisor chooses Reopen, picks the reason, and the attendant is told.

Why did my unfinished rooms disappear after my shift?

They went back to the pool so the next shift can be assigned them. Your supervisor was notified.